

Luke A. Townrow

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Education

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| Johns Hopkins University
Ph.D. in Psychological & Brain Sciences
Advisor: Dr. Christopher Krupenye | Aug 2022 - Present |
| Johns Hopkins University
Masters in Psychological & Brain Sciences
Advisor: Dr. Christopher Krupenye | Aug 2022 - Apr 2024 |
| Durham University
Masters by Research (MScR) in Psychology
Thesis Title: Empathy's Effect on Spontaneous Perspective-Taking
Advisors: Prof. Zanna Clay, Prof. Daniel Smith, & Dr. Christopher Krupenye | Oct 2021 - Sept 2022 |
| Cardiff University
BSc Psychology with Professional Placement
Placement: Prof. Josep Call's lab at the University of St. Andrews
Mentors: Prof. John M. Pearce & Prof. Peter White | Sept 2017 - May 2021 |

Publications

(*corresponding author, °Undergraduate mentee)

Townrow, L. A.* & Krupenye, C. (2025). Bonobos Point More for Ignorant Than Knowledgeable Social Partners. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 122(6)

Townrow, L. A.* & Krupenye, C. (2025). Reply to Royka & Santos: Representing ignorance, and the evolution of theory of mind. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*

Townrow, L. A.* & Krupenye, C. (2025). Reply to Tauzin: How to Implement Novelty in Theory of Mind Tasks. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*

Jordan, E. J., **Townrow, L. A.**, Wright, C. I., & Seed, A. M. (2020). Understanding solidity: Investigating knowledge of a functional object property in brown capuchin monkeys (*Sapajus apella*) and common squirrel monkeys (*Saimiri sciureus*). *Animal Behavior and Cognition*, 7(3), 365-391

Manuscripts in Preparation

(*corresponding author)

Townrow, L. A.* & Krupenye, C. Bonobos Tease a Human Experimenter by Monitoring Nuanced Cues of Attention. (*in prep*)

Townrow, L. A.*, Qian, M.*^o, Kano, F., Call, J. & Krupenye, C. Implicit and explicit measures suggest continuities in mechanisms of false belief tracking in humans and other apes. (*in prep*)

Royka, A., **Townrow, L. A.**, Baker, A., Berke, A. & Santos, L. (2026). Monkeys fail intuitive physics inference tasks. (*in prep*)

Royka, A., **Townrow, L. A.**, Meade, M., & Santos, L. (2026). The Limits of Primate Gaze-Following: Rhesus macaques follow intentionally deflected gazes. (*in prep*)

Awards

2025. Walter L. Clark Teaching Award. This award recognizes a graduate student who has demonstrated an aptitude for instruction in the classroom, leveraging their depth of knowledge and effective communication skills to enhance the undergraduate educational experience. \$500

2024. Robert S. Waldrop Jr Investigator Award. This award recognizes a graduate student who has demonstrated exceptional scholarly progress in pre-dissertation graduate research (3rd year or prior) as evidenced by performance on Psychological and Brain Science department seminars, area seminars, publications, etc. \$500

2024. Special Conference Travel Award. This travel award is in place to promote excellence in research and training. This award helped fund my attendance to an international training workshop designed to provide in-depth teaching of noninvasive technological methods, such as eye-tracking, pupillometry, thermal imaging and machine learning (*Bridging the Technological Gap Workshop - Leipzig, Germany*). \$1,000

Conference Presentations & Posters

(Poster) Implicit and explicit measures suggest continuities in mechanisms of false belief tracking in humans and other apes. Townrow, L. A., Qian, M., Kano, F., & Krupenye, C. *Conference for Comparative Cognition (CO3)*. Montreal, Canada. 2026.

(Invited Symposia) Bonobos Point More for Ignorant Than Knowledgeable Social Partners **Townrow, L. A.** & Krupenye, C. *Behavior 2025 / XXXVIII International Ethological Congress. Comparative Cognition Society*. Kolkata, India. 2025.

(Talk) Bonobos Tease a Human Experimenter by Monitoring Nuanced Cues of Attention. **Townrow, L. A.** & Krupenye, C. *Comparative Cognition Society*. Albuquerque, New Mexico, USA. 2025.

(Talk) Bonobos Tease a Human Experimenter by Monitoring Nuanced Cues of Attention. **Townrow, L. A.** & Krupenye, C. *American Association of Biological Anthropology*. Baltimore, Maryland, USA. 2025.

(Talk) Bonobos Point More for Ignorant Than Knowledgeable Social Partners. **Townrow, L. A.** & Krupenye, C. *Comparative Cognition Society*. Albuquerque, New Mexico, USA. 2024.

(Poster) Bonobos Point More for Ignorant Than Knowledgeable Social Partners. **Townrow, L. A.** & Krupenye, C. *Bridging the Technological Gap Workshop - Max Planck Institute (MPI EVA)*, Leipzig, Germany. 2024.

(Poster) Are Nonhuman Primates Able to Represent Altercentric Ignorance in Others and Flexibly Communicate Accordingly? **Townrow, L. A.** & Krupenye, C. *Mechanisms of Learning Forum - Organised by Emory University and University of St. Andrews*. Edinburgh, Scotland, UK. 2023.

Invited Talks

Nonhuman Primate Theory of Mind: An Investigation into Cues & Representations. **Global Research Center for Diverse Intelligences** at the University of St Andrews. **upcoming 2026*

Nonhuman Primate Theory of Mind: Across Implicit & Explicit Measures of Cognition. Cognitive Science Department - **UC San Diego**. **upcoming 2026*

Nonhuman Primate Theory of Mind: Cues, Representations & Evolutionary Continuity. Comparative and Evolutionary Research Club in the School of Psychology, Sport and Health Sciences - **University of Portsmouth**. 2026

Nonhuman Primate Theory of Mind: An Investigation into Cues & Representations. Dr. Laura Lewis' Comparative Cognition Lab - **UC Santa Barbara**. 2025

Theory of Mind & Me: My Background, Experiences & Research. Dr. Natalie Awad Schwob's Primate Minds seminar class - **Bucknell University**. 2025

Nonhuman Primate Theory of Mind: An Investigation into Cues & Representations. Behavior and Evolution Research Group, hosted by Dr. Alejandro Sanchez Amaro's Comparative Cognition Lab - **University of Stirling**. 2025

Nonhuman Primate Theory of Mind: An Investigation into Cues & Representations. Dr. Federico Rossano's Comparative Cognition Lab - **UC San Diego**. 2025

Nonhuman Primate Theory of Mind: An Investigation into Cues & Representations. Professor Laurie Santos' Canine & Primate Laboratory - **Yale University**. 2024

Nonhuman Great Ape Theory of Mind: Eyes as a window into the mind. Indianapolis Zoo, invited by Dr. Rob Shumaker and Dr. Christopher Martin - **Indianapolis Zoo**. 2024

Research Experience

Humans

- Cardiff University - *Cardiff (UK)*
- Durham University - *Durham (UK)*
- Johns Hopkins University - *Baltimore, (MD, USA)*

Nonhuman Primates

- Chimpanzees - Leipzig Zoo (GER) Wolfgang Kohler Primate Research Center (WKPRC)
- Bonobos - Leipzig Zoo (GER) Wolfgang Kohler Primate Research Center (WKPRC)
- Orangutans - Leipzig Zoo (GER) Wolfgang Kohler Primate Research Center (WKPRC)
- Chimpanzees - Edinburgh Zoo (SCO) Budongo Research Unit (BRU)
- Capuchin Monkeys - Edinburgh Zoo (SCO) Living Links
- Squirrel Monkeys - Edinburgh Zoo (SCO) Living Links
- Geladas - Edinburgh Zoo (SCO) Living Links
- Bonobos – Ape Initiative (IA, USA)
- Orangutans - Indianapolis Zoo (IN, USA)
- Rhesus Macaques – Cayo Santiago, Punta Santiago (PR, USA)
- Sulawesi Macaques – Sulawesi Field Site (Online Behavioral Coding) (IDN)

Other

- Dogs - Johns Hopkins University (*MD, US*) Social and Cognitive Origins Group

Teaching Experience

*2026 Dec Leading 3-Day Workshop on Nonhuman Great Ape Eye-Tracking: Background, Practices & Workshop. Dr. Amalia Bastos' Lab - University of St Andrews.

2026 Spring Guest lecturer for Professor Christopher Krupenye and his Origins of the Social Mind undergraduate class.

2025 Spring Teaching assistant and section leader for Dr. Jeffery Bowen and his Design and Analysis undergraduate class (*Advanced TA Placement*).

2024 Fall Teaching assistant and guest lecturer for Professor Christopher Krupenye and his Primate Minds undergraduate class.

2024 Spring Teaching assistant and guest lecturer for Professor Christopher Krupenye and his Origins of the Social Mind undergraduate class.

2023 Fall Teaching assistant for Professor Lisa Feigenson and her Developmental Psychology undergraduate class.

Advising & Mentorship

Melodie Qian. Undergraduate Student at Johns Hopkins University (2023 - Present). Project titled: *Implicit and explicit measures suggest continuities in mechanisms of false belief tracking in humans and other apes.*

Melina Hidalgo-Ramirez. Undergraduate Student at Johns Hopkins University (2024 - 2025). Project titled: *Utilizing pupillometry and eye tracking to assess causal understanding of emotions in human adults.*

Media Coverage

My work has been covered in media outlets including but not limited to:

- [Nature Research Highlights Article](#)
- [NPR \(National Public Radio\)](#)
- [Smithsonian Magazine](#)
- [New Scientist](#)
- [CNN \(Cable News Network\)](#)
- [BBC / CBBC](#)
- [CBC \(Canadian Broadcast Corporation\) Radio Interview](#)
- [El Pais](#)
- [Johns Hopkins University HUB](#)

Journal Refereeing Experience

I have reviewed peer review articles for the following journals:

- *Proceedings of the Royal Society B*
- *Scientific Reports*
- *Animal Behavior and Cognition*
- *Psychological Topics*